

Do You Know Where Your Project Lives Right Now?

Every Pennebaker project moves through six phases — from first bid to final closeout. Can you map your current project to the right phase and name what you own in it? By the end of this course, you can.

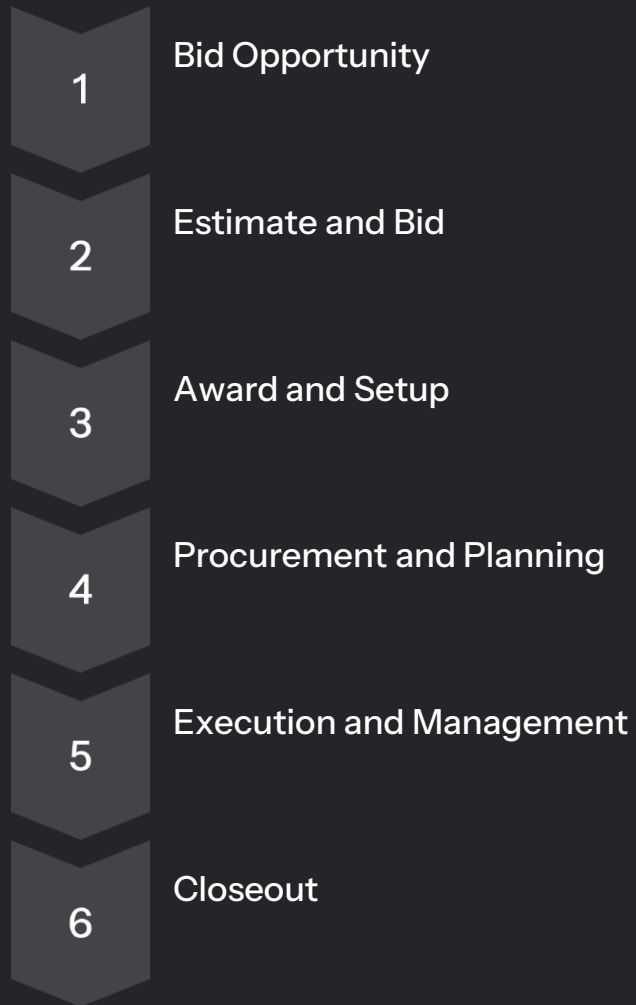


What This Course Will Do for You

Six phases. Your responsibilities at each one. Where the process is solid — and where the gaps are real. You will leave able to map any project, catch the risks early, and work the gaps with confidence.



The Six Phases — Your Shared Mental Map



Think of these as six rooms you walk through on every project — in order, every time. This map was built from one experienced PM's interview. It is version 0.3, still in discovery. Knowing where the map has gaps is part of doing the job well right now.

Who Owns What — Roles Across the Lifecycle

Bid Coordinator (Brandy)

manages the bid calendar and due dates

Estimating Team (Jay and others)

leads formal takeoff and bid assembly

Contract Administration

handles contracts, bonding, and notices to proceed

Project Coordinator (Jasmine)

issues purchase orders

PM

coordinates submittals, procurement requests, field execution, and progress

⚠️ PMs do not sign contracts. PMs do not issue purchase orders directly.

The Swimlane — Locate Yourself on the Map

This diagram shows all six phases across the top and every role as its own row. Each box shows who does what and when. The arrows show handoffs. Your instructor can walk you through any row or cell on this diagram — just ask.





Module 1 Activity — Six-Phase Check

Ask your instructor to run the six-phase check. Say: "**Run the six-phase check.**"

Your instructor will name a phase at random. Respond with the role that owns it and one thing the PM does or does not do in that phase. You will go through all six.



How Bids Come In — Pathway to the Estimate

Bid opportunities arrive through websites, email, and phone calls. Brandy places them on the calendar — sometimes at operations leadership's direction — and notifies the team. The PM is not responsible for initial intake screening.

When a pre-bid walkthrough is required, the PM attends, takes notes and photos, identifies subcontractors needed, and uploads everything to the J Drive. No standard site-walk checklist exists yet. Consistent habits matter until one does.

Two Estimating Pathways — Know Which One You Are On

Pathway A — Formal Coordinated Bid

larger scopes or piping takeoff go to the estimating team; they use Trimble AutoBid for quantities, labor, and material from drawings; the PM supports but does not perform drawing-based takeoff

Pathway B — PM-Led Direct Request

a client contacts the PM directly; the PM visits the site, takes notes and photos, emails subcontractors for pricing, copies Jasmine, and builds the estimate using AutoBid symbols or the Excel change-order template

Either way, the PM and operations leadership review the margin and labor hours together before anything goes out. Labor-hour estimates currently come from personal installation experience — no standard reference table exists yet.

Building the Estimate — What the PM Actually Does

PM-led estimates use two tools

simple AutoBid symbol and cost entries, or the Excel change-order template with built-in formulas

The PM assigns labor hours to each activity

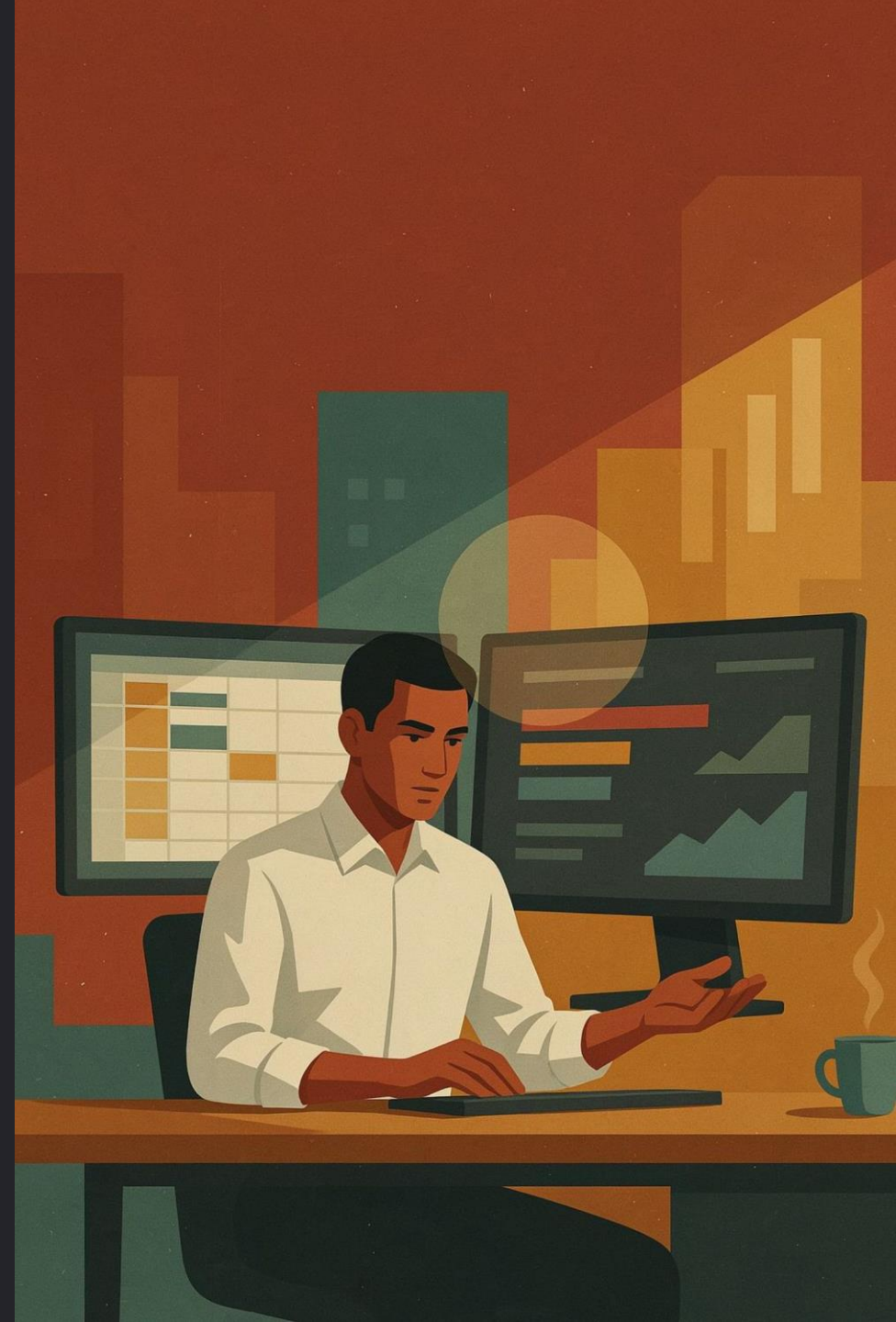
enters material costs, and plugs in subcontractor quotes

Subcontractor requests for pricing — RFPs — go out by email

and Jasmine is copied; that copy creates a record even though no formal quote-log system is confirmed

Before the estimate moves forward

the PM and operations leadership review margin and hours together





Module 2 Activity — Estimating Pathway Scenario

Ask your instructor to run the estimating pathway scenario. Say: "**Give me a scenario.**"

Your instructor will describe a job situation. Tell your instructor which pathway applies, what your first three actions would be, and who you copy or notify. Your instructor will give you feedback based on the source materials.

From Award to Active Job — The Handoff Sequence

When a bid is won, the client issues a letter of intent or notice to proceed.
Contract administration takes over: formal contract, bonding, NTP processing.
The PM does not sign contracts.

The PM's role begins when the job is activated: active folder on the J Drive, PM number assigned. The exact sequence and authority to begin mobilizing are not yet standardized — when something feels unclear, ask rather than assume.



Submittals — The Procurement Starting Line

A submittal is a document from a vendor or manufacturer showing exactly what will be installed. The PM obtains the vendor submittal, reviews it, and sends it to the owner or architect for approval.

Plan for roughly two weeks to gather submittals and two weeks for owner or architect review — those are estimates, not guarantees.

After approval, the PM requests a purchase order from Jasmine by email or by phone. PMs do not have access to the PO software system.



The PO Request — A Documented Gap

When the PM requests a PO, there is currently no verified budget check before the request goes in. There is no formal purchase approval step and no confirmed audit trail.

Colleagues are copied on emails as an informal safeguard — that is not a controlled process.

⚠ Recognize this gap. Document your PO requests carefully until a better process is in place.

Scheduling and Manpower — Working Without a Net

Most projects: the PM mentally plans activities, sequences, durations, and communicates through email and conversation. Handwritten notes and phone reminders are common tools.

Some larger clients require a formal Gantt chart in Microsoft Project — a bar chart showing each task, its dates, and how tasks connect. If the PM lacks access, the information goes to an administrative coordinator for entry.

Manpower coordination has no fixed weekly meeting and no standard allocation rule. Group scheduling meetings happen but not on a set cadence.

 This is a known gap, not an oversight on your part. Flag conflicts early and in writing.



ProjectSight and the Data Landscape

ProjectSight is the field-facing platform used at Pennebaker. Field crews access drawings, submittals, RFIs, and daily reports through iPads and ProjectSight. An RFI is a request for information — a formal question sent to the architect or engineer when something on the drawings is unclear.

ProjectSight's primary value today is as a shared document library, not an active project control system. ProjectSight and Trimble AutoBid do not interface. Data lives across four places: accounting systems, ProjectSight, AutoBid, and the J Drive.



Module 3 Activity — Procurement and Scheduling Role-Play

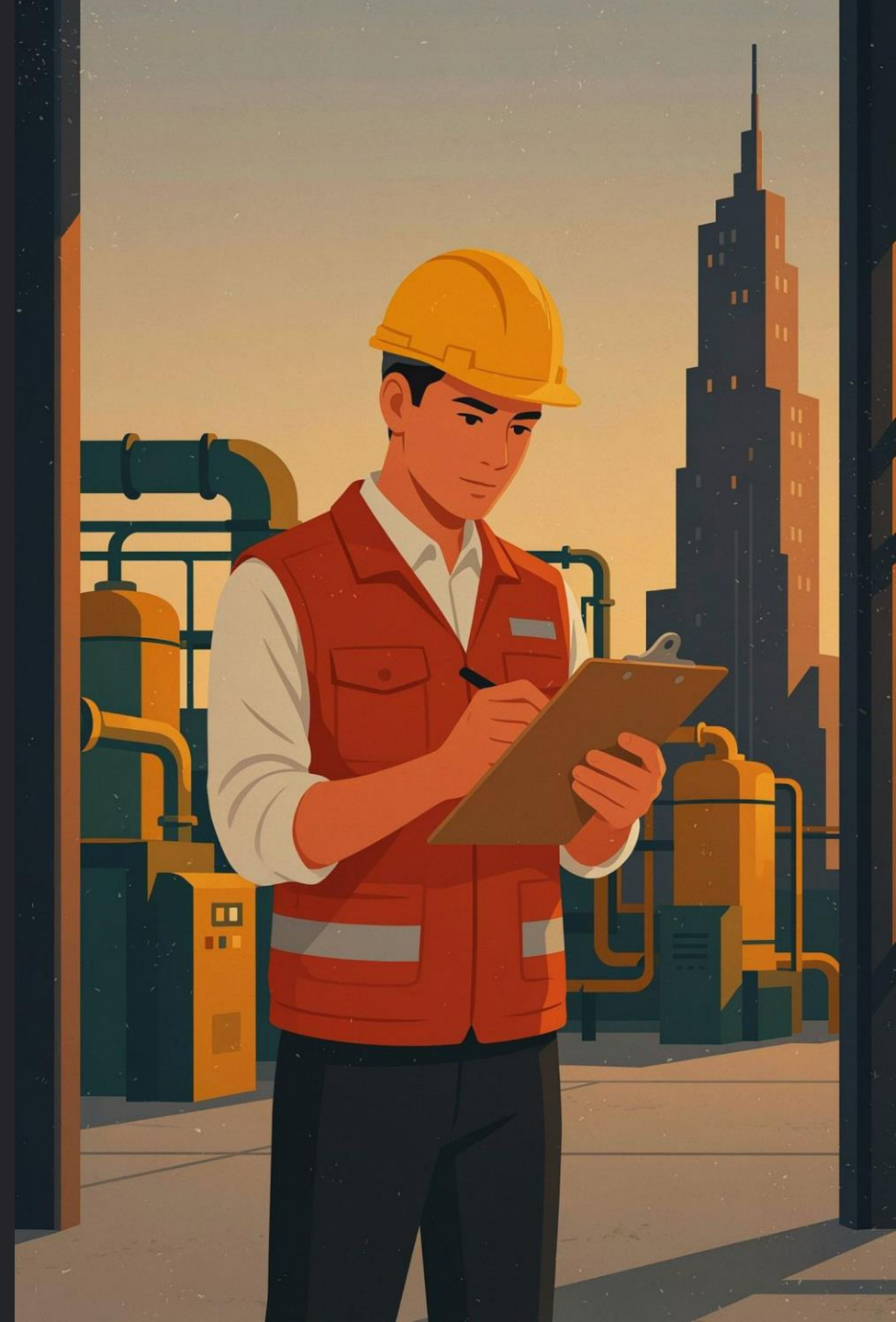
Ask your instructor to run the procurement and scheduling role-play. Say: "**Start the procurement scenario.**"

Your situation: submittals just got approved, materials need to be ordered, and you have a manpower question. Walk through your steps out loud. Your instructor will prompt you when you skip a step or hit a gap.

Tracking Progress — What Percent Complete Actually Means

Tracking progress means estimating how much of the project is physically done. Look at quantities or work packages: how many units are installed out of the total, or whether a demolition scope is fully complete.

Combine field observations with a clear sense of what tasks remain. This is PM judgment based on field knowledge — not a company-standardized calculation method at this time.



WIP and EAC — Your Early Warning System

WIP — Work in Progress

the financial snapshot of where a project stands: how much has been earned based on work performed compared to what has been spent

EAC — Estimate at Completion

the updated prediction of what the total project will cost when it is finished

These are not just accounting terms. They tell you and the company whether a project is trending toward profit or loss while there is still time to act.



Does that definition of EAC make sense? Your instructor will pause here and check before moving on.

The WIP Gap — What the Current State Looks Like

There is no formal EAC update process at the PM level right now. Operations leadership has recently requested WIP reports. Many PMs are still becoming familiar with what WIP means.

One experienced PM expressed the view that weak WIP control is connected to project losses — an important hypothesis, even if not yet formally validated.

The authoritative definitions and calculations sit with Finance and the Workroom 31 team. When in doubt about a number, go to Finance.



Closeout — The Undocumented Phase

Closeout includes test-and-balance, startup coordination, subcontractor completion, and closeout documents. Test-and-balance — TAB — means measuring and adjusting air and water flow in HVAC systems to confirm they meet design specs.

The full closeout sequence is not documented. Punch list, final billing, retainage, warranty turnover, job cost reconciliation, and project archival are all absent from the current process description. Retainage is the portion of payment the client withholds until the project is fully complete.

 Do not assume a standard closeout process exists. Document what you do on every job and flag it as a risk on any project approaching completion.

Bringing It All Together — What Good PM Practice Looks Like Right Now

-  **Map your project to the right phase**
and know what you own in it
-  **Run the correct estimating pathway**
and document your steps
-  **Execute submittals and PO requests carefully**
knowing the gaps are real
-  **Communicate scheduling and manpower needs**
early and in writing
-  **Flag WIP and closeout risks**
before they become losses

The gaps in this process are not your fault. Naming them clearly and working around them carefully is what good PM practice looks like at Pennebaker right now.



Module 4 Activity — Lifecycle Mapping Exercise

Ask your instructor to run the lifecycle mapping exercise. Say: "**Map my project.**"

Describe a real or hypothetical Pennebaker project at any phase. Walk your instructor through where the project sits, your next three actions, the handoffs you need to make, and the gaps you are watching. Your instructor will probe for anything you miss.

Optional Knowledge Check

A private knowledge check is available — nothing is recorded and results are for your use only.

It covers phase ownership, estimating pathways, PO and submittal workflow, WIP and EAC concepts, and closeout gap awareness.

Recommended if you want to confirm your footing before applying any of this on a live project. Ask your instructor: "**Start the knowledge check.**"



You Have the Map — Now Use It

You can now name all six phases, identify who owns each one, and locate yourself on the lifecycle at any moment.

Your next step: pull up one of your active projects and map it to the phase it is in right now. Identify the next handoff you owe and one gap you are watching.

Thank you for your time today. The process is still being built — and so are you.

